

What You Can Make with Claude

faculty projects, ordered from familiar text toward unfamiliar code — and past it

A review of what faculty are building, arranged on one axis. It begins in the writing you already command and descends toward forms that did not exist two years ago. Each row is a genre of output. Examples at left. One project **unpacked** at right: situation, inputs, operations, outputs, and the interface suited to it (CHAT COWORK CODE). The loop is constant — inputs, operations, outputs. Only the medium changes. Begin where you are fluent. Descend.

1 Structured Text & Documents

MOST FAMILIAR

EXAMPLES

- Email to a chair proposing a new course
- Grant Specific Aims page from a project description
- Committee report from raw meeting notes
- Recommendation letter from a CV and a prompt
- Conference abstract from a draft paper
- Syllabus skeleton from a reading list

UNPACKED

Meeting notes → a clean report for the dean

SITUATION	Messy notes from a faculty meeting; a structured report due tomorrow.
INPUTS	meeting-notes.md — your raw bullet points.
OPERATIONS	One prompt: "turn these into a report with a summary, decisions made, and action items with owners and dates."
OUTPUTS	report.md, or a polished .docx on request.
BEST FIT	CHAT COWORK CODE IF REPEATED MONTHLY

2 Reference Pages static HTML

INTRO TO CODE

EXAMPLES

- A searchable glossary of course terms
- A one-page syllabus website
- A printable command/reference dashboard
- An illustrated lecture handout
- A course-policy FAQ page

UNPACKED

A glossary your students can search and copy from

SITUATION	One page holding every key term in your course, searchable, works offline.
INPUTS	glossary.md — terms and definitions.
OPERATIONS	"Build a single-file HTML page with a search box and click-to-copy, styled for comfortable reading."
OUTPUTS	glossary.html — one file you can email or host anywhere.
BEST FIT	CODE COWORK

3 Web Apps Next.js

MORE COMPLEX

EXAMPLES

- A course website with interactive concept demos
- A reading-response collection app
- An interactive timeline of a period or movement
- A "build your own X" student exercise

UNPACKED

Course site for GENED 1049 East Asian Cinema

SITUATION	A site pairing a cinematography glossary with demos built on the films you actually teach.
INPUTS	Syllabus, Rashomon stills, glossary text.
OPERATIONS	Scaffold a Next.js app, build parametric demo components, deploy to Vercel.
OUTPUTS	A live site (gened-1049.vercel.app) you share by link.
BEST FIT	CODE

Turn over. The axis continues: connected tools, visualization, orchestration. Then it leaves the page.

...and further down the spine

connected tools, visualizations, agentic systems — and what's past the bottom edge

4 Bots & Connected ToolsMCP, Slack

TODAY'S TOPIC

EXAMPLES ■ Claude connected to Semantic Scholar for live literature search ■ An art-history lecture pulling live images from Harvard Art Museums ■ A Slack bot that answers from your course materials ■ An oral-exam practice bot ■ Claude connected to your Google Drive	UNPACKED
	An art-history lecture, illustrated from the museum's own records
	SITUATION
	INPUTS
	OPERATIONS
	OUTPUTS
BEST FIT	

5 Data Visualizationsd3, three.js

EVEN MORE COMPLEX

EXAMPLES ■ A 2D semantic-embedding map of a text corpus ■ An interactive chart of course-evaluation trends ■ A 3D model of a molecule, artifact, or building ■ A network graph of citations or characters ■ An animated explainer for a hard concept	UNPACKED
	Calvino's Six Memos, by the numbers
	SITUATION
	INPUTS
	OPERATIONS
	OUTPUTS
BEST FIT	

6 Agentic Pipelines & Systems

MOST COMPLEX

EXAMPLES ■ Close-reading a whole corpus with parallel subagents ■ A reproducible coding pipeline for interview transcripts ■ An automated weekly research digest (scheduled) ■ A recommendation engine grounded in institutional data	UNPACKED
	Naming every writer cited across 538 Dylan songs
	SITUATION
	INPUTS
	OPERATIONS
	OUTPUTS
BEST FIT	

? Unknown ???

BEYOND THE MAP

One day, a sort of Gesamtkunstwerk. Past the bottom: potentially new mediums, or new combinations of the rows above — text, application, visualization, sound, physical space in one project — buildable as the remaining technical barriers come down. Too early to catalogue.

The whole axis is one loop: inputs, operations, outputs. Descent changes a single variable — how much of the loop is code. Worked versions of most rows live in this repo's [examples/more-examples/](#).